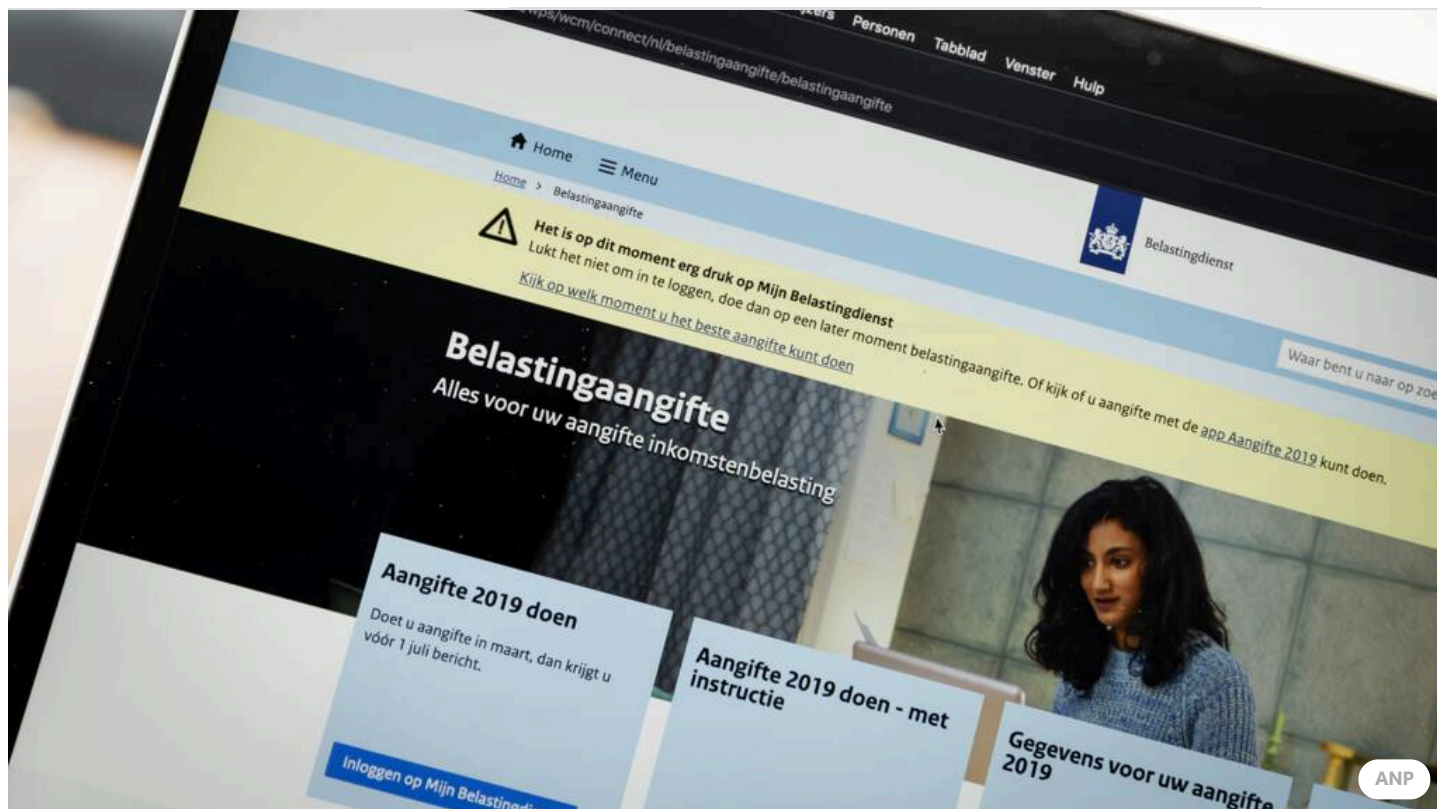




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The Tax Authorities checked people with dual nationality extra strictly.

Between 2012 and 2015, the Tax and Customs Administration subjected a portion of people with a second nationality to extra checks during their income tax returns. The Tax and Customs Administration has confirmed this following an investigation by [Fidelity](#) and [RTLNews](#).

Having a second nationality was one of five criteria used by the tax authorities for additional checks, RTL and Trouw report. According to the Tax and Customs Administration, using this method, 11,000 people with dual nationality were checked more strictly than other citizens.

As of 2014, a second nationality is no longer registered in the Personal Records Database. In a letter to the House of Representatives, State Secretaries Vrijlbrief and Van Huffelen state that since 2015, there have been no additional checks on declarations by people with second nationalities.

To date, people without Dutch nationality who are liable for tax here are still being selected by the system for additional checks. This extra income tax check will stop as of this coming May 15, Vijlbrief and Van Huffelen promise. This should actually have been removed from the systems as early as the end of 2019, but that did not happen.

It is unclear how many people were checked extra as a result of this. It is also unclear which nationalities were checked extra during all those years.

Ethnic profiling

The Tax and Customs Administration denies that selection was made during the checks not only based on nationality but also on race or ethnic origin. The Dutch Data Protection Authority has been investigating this since last year. Several people have filed complaints about ethnic profiling.

A second investigation into the state of affairs at the Tax and Customs Administration is being conducted by the Government Audit Service. That service is investigating how the selection rules and criteria for additional checks on taxpayers were established and whether they are legal.

"We strongly condemn ethnic profiling," Vijlbrief and Van Huffelen reiterate in their letter today. They also consider discrimination based on nationality undesirable. There must be an explicit legal basis before the Tax and Customs Administration is allowed to consider nationality.

Childcare allowance

Previous reporting by Trouw and RTL regarding the abuses surrounding the childcare allowance revealed that many families wrongly treated as fraudsters held a second nationality.

The fact that these people were dealt with strictly has nothing to do with that, says the Tax and Customs Administration. In these cases, the only thing checked was whether the parents had Dutch nationality, because otherwise they might not be entitled to the allowance. Whether that is correct will have to be determined by the various investigations.

Parents will receive a refund of the contribution for closed childcare this summer.

